The 720: TSMC, MiniMax, China Data Centers, Yum China, Li Ning, CR Beer, Japan Autos, FMG downgrade, CICC

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In Focus | TSMC

TSMC – Accelerating Capacity Build to Secure Stronger Growth – Buy. TSMC will host its 2Q26 analyst meeting on 16 July 2026. We continue to view AI/HPC demand as a multi-year structural growth engine for TSMC. Over the past quarter, we see even stronger momentum for 2027 especially from AI accelerators and server CPUs, with demand continuing to run well ahead of supply. Against this backdrop, we expect TSMC to further accelerate its capacity build and capex into 2027 and beyond. We lift our 2027 capex forecast to US$78bn and raise our end-2027 N3 and N2 wafer-out capacity estimates to 200kwpm and 140kwpm, respectively, alongside higher CoWoS capacity projections. We increase our 2026-2028 EPS estimates by 6% to 9%, modeling a structurally higher gross margin trajectory reaching 67.3% by 2028. This margin upside is supported by strategic pricing, a favorable product mix, and continued productivity improvements that should largely offset overseas fab dilution. 12m TP lifted to NT$3,000. *Evelyn Yu*

Themes in Play | MiniMax, China Data Centers, Japan Autos

MiniMax Group – NDR Highlights and Positive Read-Across from DeepSeek – Buy. We hosted MiniMax's Investor Relations team, where management reiterated strong ARR momentum and confidence in its US$1bn year-end 2026 target. We view DeepSeek's recent introduction of peak-hour API pricing as a positive read-through for MiniMax M3's performance and price competitiveness, signaling that China AI model pricing may be moving toward a more rational phase. MiniMax remains well positioned to capture global TAM growth across text, multi-modal, and agentic workflows, supported by its cost-efficient architecture and upcoming H3 video generation model launch. We maintain our Buy rating and 12m TP of HK$860. *Ronald Keung*

China Data Centers – AI Computing Conference Highlights. We expect China's national computing power network to reshape the competitive landscape and geographic footprint of the domestic data center industry over the next five years. Capital and technology are heavily shifting toward Western China hubs, while the value proposition of tier-1 city data centers transitions toward ultra-low latency hot compute, edge nodes, and AI inference. Furthermore, the emergence of GW-scale computing clusters introduces higher technology and resource barriers, providing clear differentiation among operators. Within our coverage, we highlight Buy-rated VNET, GDS, and Range Intelligent as well-positioned to navigate these evolving industry dynamics. *Timothy Zhao*

Japan Automobiles – Earnings Forecasts Revised Upward. We revise upward our FY3/27-FY3/29 earnings forecasts for the five automakers in our coverage, driven by favorable US sales, lower crude oil prices, and a weaker yen assumption of ¥160, which offset higher memory prices. Specifically, our FY3/27 and FY3/28 earnings estimates rise by 20% and 5% on average, respectively, as automakers secure profits ahead of anticipated cost-push inflation. Consequently, we raise our 12m TPs for Buy-rated Honda to ¥1,850, Buy-rated Subaru to ¥3,550, and Neutral-rated Mazda to ¥1,300, while leaving Toyota and Nissan unchanged. We remain constructive on automakers benefiting from the structural shift toward hybrid vehicles in the US market. *Kota Yuzawa*

China Consumer | Yum China, Li Ning, CR Beer

Yum China – 2Q26 Preview: SSSG Improvement on Track – Buy (on CL). We expect Yum China to deliver sequential same-store sales growth improvement in 2Q26, forecasting +1% year-over-year for both KFC and Pizza Hut despite a softer macroeconomic backdrop. We project 11% year-over-year sales growth and anticipate profitability will be supported by cost control capabilities, offsetting a high margin base and headwinds from an increasing delivery mix. We fine-tune our 2026-28 net income forecasts by less than 1% to reflect revised FX assumptions and higher revaluation losses. We maintain our 12m TPs of US$58/HK$452. *Michelle Cheng*

Li Ning – Muted Near-Term Demand with 2H-Weighted Brand Investments – Buy. We maintain our Buy rating and HK$26.7 12m TP following management meetings that highlighted a soft second-quarter demand backdrop and deeper industry discounting. Trends softened across core categories including basketball, running, and lifestyle, though outdoor and Golden Label delivered solid growth. We expect operating margin pressure this year from a second-half-weighted expense cadence driven by higher advertising and promotion costs, partially offset by supply chain cost reductions and narrower impairment charges. Management also plans to establish a separate business unit to independently manage the Curry brand. *Michelle Cheng*

China Resources Beer – Full-Year Targets Maintained with Intact Premiumization – Buy. We reiterate our Buy rating and HK$34.73 12m TP following management meetings where the company maintained its full-year targets of low-single-digit volume growth and 4-5% ASP growth. Management noted sequential volume improvement in June supported by slightly better consumption sentiment, with the sub-premium and above segment accelerating and Heineken maintaining over 20% volume growth. We expect beer operating margins to expand on stable gross margins and operating expense savings, while the company targets a 55-60% dividend payout ratio for 2026. *Leaf Liu*

New | FMG downgrade

Fortescue Metals – Mine Replacement Challenges and Valuation – Downgrade to Sell. We downgrade Fortescue Metals Group to Sell from Neutral and lower our 12m TP by 11% to A$16.90, driven by near-term iron ore price weakness, Pilbara mine replacement challenges, and a stretched valuation. We see headwinds to cash flow from rising mine replacement and decarbonization capex, which we expect to stay elevated at over US$4bn annually through the end of the decade. Additionally, the near-term outlook for iron ore appears challenging, with the potential for the 61% Index to drop below US$95/dmt and lower-grade realizations to fall further amid ongoing negotiations with China Minerals Resource Group. Consequently, we reduce our NAV estimate by 14% to

A$17.50 per share, noting the stock trades at a premium to peers. *Paul Young*

GS Event | CICC, MinebeaMitsumi

China International Capital Corp – Management Meeting Takeaways – Buy/Neutral. We maintain our Buy/Neutral ratings on CICC-H/CICC-A with 12m TPs of HK$30.45/Rmb45.72 following management meetings highlighting prudent risk management in the cross-border total return swap business. Investment banking continues its strong performance with a market-leading IPO share in Hong Kong, supported by a robust pipeline of tech companies and international issuers. The ongoing merger transaction is on track for a third-quarter closing, after which the firm will focus on deploying new capital to restore its return on equity to at least 10%. Management also plans to further expand the highly profitable international balance sheet. *Shuo Yang*

MinebeaMitsumi – CEO/COO meeting: AI Servers and Humanoids Driving Growth – Buy. CEO Yoshihisa Kainuma's view is that the biggest wave of demand since the company's founding is approaching, and the company will capture demand to the maximum extent possible to avoid opportunity losses. Specifically, management expects AI server sales to reach ¥200 bn by FY3/29 and targets an ROE of 15% or higher driven by an expanding lineup of highly profitable products and improving motor margins. We believe the company's valuation will rise as a physical AI-related stock as it captures this unprecedented demand and avoids opportunity losses. 12m TP of ¥5,500. *Daiki Takayama*

Australia Strategy | FY26 review

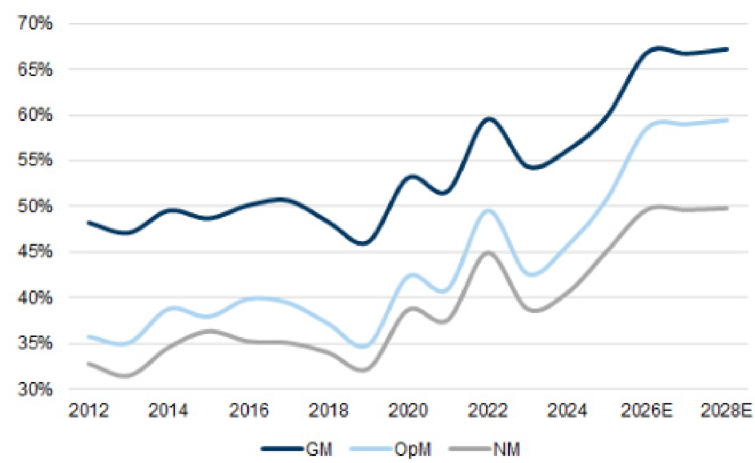
Australia – FY26 Review: Carried by Commodities. The ASX 200 rose 6.1% in FY26, driven largely by a 47% gain in Resources, while the index excluding Resources fell 4.6%. The market delivered its first earnings upgrade cycle since FY22, again led by Resources, even as Industrials EPS was cut 10% and index-level valuations de-rated 13%. Our Quality factor fell 38%, the worst in 25 years, dragged down by Healthcare and Tech, while Value outperformed Growth by 32% on a narrow rally in Gold and Mining. Looking ahead, further gains for domestic cyclicals and small caps likely hinge on inflation and interest rates moderating without a deterioration in the growth backdrop. *Tony Wu*

Around the world | US Strategy, US Payrolls

US Strategy – Decomposing Russell 2000 Outperformance and H2 Outlook. We expect Russell 2000 index outperformance to fade in the second half of the year, pointing to low single-digit returns over the next 12 months driven by elevated valuations and near-trend US economic growth. While the index returned 23% in the first half fueled by the AI trade, a robust economy, and surging healthcare M&A, the recent index reconstitution cut the weight of AI infrastructure stocks from 15% to 7%. Furthermore, analysts have cut 2026 EPS estimates for the small-cap index by 9% year-to-date. Nonetheless, with return dispersion surging to some of the highest levels in recent decades, we believe the small-cap universe will remain exceptionally fertile ground for alpha generation. *Ben Snider*

USA – Payroll Growth Below Expectations. We note that June nonfarm payrolls rose by a below-consensus 57k, with downward revisions of 43k and 31k to May and April, bringing the three-month average to 111k. The unemployment rate declined by 11bp to 4.19%, driven by a 720k drop in the labor force that was concentrated among workers aged 25-34. Average hourly earnings increased 0.35% month-over-month, in line with expectations, while initial jobless claims ticked down slightly to 215k. *Jan Hatzius*

Graphic language | TSMC (Buy) - Margin Trends



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

GS Events (Home Page here)

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